

Site Screening Memorandum - Parcel B

Illustrative adjacent-location contrast | Sloan Canyon conservation boundary scenario, Southern Nevada | Prepared for RAI mock-data ingestion

PRELIMINARY RESULT: NO-GO / RE-SITE

Project	RAI Solar B - same 180 MWac design basis as Parcel A
Real-world location	Southern Nevada, immediately across a hypothetical land-management boundary from the viable Eldorado Valley screening area
Illustrative site condition	Synthetic parcel intentionally placed inside the Sloan Canyon National Conservation Area boundary for the mock comparison.
Target COD	Q4 2029 (synthetic; not achievable on this site under the assumed footprint)
Decision standard	Fatal-flaw screen: land-use designation overrides otherwise attractive solar resource, terrain and market conditions.

RAI Five-Factor Risk Assessment

Risk factor	Assessment	RAI score	Key evidence
LAND	CRITICAL	12/100	Assumed project footprint falls inside a National Conservation Area managed for protection of cultural, natural and wilderness values. Re-site required.
LAW	CRITICAL	8/100	The conservation designation creates a fundamental land-use conflict for a new utility-scale solar field under this mock scenario. Normal project permitting cannot cure the siting problem.
FINANCE	CRITICAL	22/100	Development spend becomes stranded if land status is discovered late. Synthetic sunk-cost exposure after 12 months: \$4.8M.
MATERIALS	LOW	82/100	Equipment availability is not the binding constraint; material risk is irrelevant if the site cannot proceed.
DEMAND	LOW-MODERATE	80/100	Regional demand may be attractive, but a strong market cannot overcome a fatal land-use constraint.

Why this site fails despite being next to a good solar market

- The solar resource, regional transmission network and market conditions can look almost identical to the neighboring viable screening area.
- The decisive difference is land status. Sloan Canyon is a federally designated National Conservation Area managed to preserve and protect cultural features, natural resources and wilderness values.
- BLM's utility-scale solar framework excludes sensitive and specially designated lands from solar development. A developer cannot treat proximity to existing solar projects as evidence that an adjacent parcel is buildable.
- RAI should elevate land-management designation above favorable commodity prices, irradiance, demand or preliminary project economics.

Illustrative conflict discovered by RAI

- Uploaded developer site-control map labels the tract "Eldorado East Expansion" and assumes utility-scale solar is allowed.
- RAI geospatial/legal cross-check identifies the synthetic footprint as falling within the Sloan Canyon NCA boundary.
- The financial workbook still carries \$4.8M of pre-NTP development costs and a Q4 2029 COD because the model was copied from Parcel A.
- RAI flags the inconsistency: the schedule and financial model assume a developable site, while land-management evidence indicates a fatal siting conflict.
- Recommended action: stop discretionary spend, preserve transferable studies, and move the project footprint back to an eligible Energy Resource / otherwise available development area.

Secondary risks that should NOT distract from the fatal flaw

- Commodity prices could improve and module costs could decline.
- A buyer could offer an attractive PPA.
- The site could have excellent irradiance and gentle slopes.
- A nearby transmission line could have capacity.
- None of these factors resolves an incompatible protected-land designation for the assumed solar-array footprint.

Mock cost of discovering the issue late

- Land option and legal diligence: \$0.45M.
- Interconnection deposit / studies: \$1.35M.
- Environmental and engineering studies: \$1.10M.
- Internal development labor and consultants: \$0.90M.
- Commercial / finance workstreams: \$1.00M.
- Illustrative avoidable spend: \$4.80M before re-site decision.

RAI expected conclusion

Parcel B should be classified as NO-GO regardless of attractive solar resource or demand assumptions. The system should explain that the land/legal conflict is a gating issue, stop downstream scoring from masking the fatal flaw, and recommend re-siting rather than mitigation.

Source Notes

The place names, planning frameworks and public-policy references below are real. Parcel boundaries, project economics, schedules, counterparties and most project-specific values are synthetic hackathon data. This is not legal, environmental, engineering, financial or permitting advice.

- Bureau of Land Management, Sloan Canyon National Conservation Area Resource Management Plan - management direction centers on preservation and protection of cultural features, natural resources and wilderness values.
- Bureau of Land Management, 2024 Western Solar Plan Record of Decision - approximately 131 million acres of BLM-administered public lands are excluded from utility-scale solar development to protect sensitive resources, including specially designated areas.
- Public Law 119-91 (May 19, 2026) adjusted the Sloan Canyon NCA boundary and increased its acreage; the mock parcel geometry in this document is synthetic and is not a cadastral or legal boundary determination.